



The Pi 2's processor is faster than before at the same price.

operations fast, reliable and cheap is what has led to their explosive usage. But due to the slick packaging and product differentiation of technology most consumers don't really have a benchmark for what a good processor can do.

The latest technology advertisements tell consumers that the latest chip from Intel is the best thing for their needs. But most consumers don't even realise what their needs are. The Apollo 11 guidance computer in 1969 used only a 1.024 MHz CPU, while an average computer today easily has a 1.2 GHz CPU power. Are we really doing that much on our computers? Well, the answer is yes and no. A huge part of our computing has become multi-tasking oriented in the past 30 years, which places huge demands on our computers. But no as well, because we are no longer doing epic teraflop consuming tasks anymore with the computers we have. The everyday home computer has become as under utilised as a 9-to-5 government employee.

Return to the Age of Innocence

The loss of wonder in the modern computer age has only just found respite thanks to the Raspberry Pi. This is not because of its power or form factor or any other superficial hardware feature - it is because users can now learn and experiment with serious processing power towards experiments that weren't worth busting a smartphone or laptop over. Prior to the Raspberry Pi the everyday user couldn't get their hands on a reasonably fast SoC if they wanted to build a processor powered device at home. Such a project would involve major investment of time and money in order to obtain a suitable processor or it would require repurposing an already available CPU from